LET’S TALK ABOUT youth

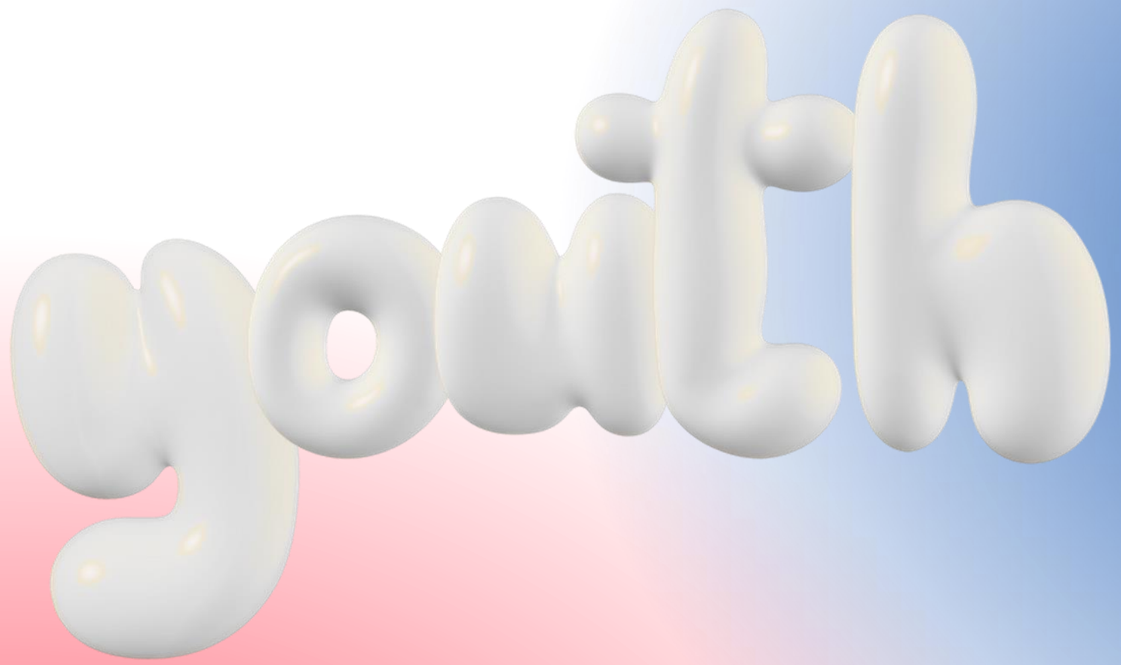
APPROACH FOR 2026

Understanding youth
- General outlook
- Consumer behavior
- Telco-specific insights

Target groups
- Target group refinement
- Brands and sinus milieus

Targets
- Short term | 2026
- Long term | 2030

Measures
- Outside-in perspective
- Value Proposition
- Communication
- Sales measures



UNDERSTANDING YOUTH

UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | General outlook

Optimism:

- More optimistic about their life/future than about society or the world

Priorities:

- Core priorities: friends, leisure, career, finances, and personal appearance
- Less priority: health and romantic relationships

Sustainability:

- Ecological consciousness & participates in demonstrations → does not always act more sustainably
- Climate and sustainability viewed as important → practical financial and career concerns often take personal precedence

Political & societal concerns:

- Affordable housing, personal finances, career prospects, social division, climate change, and right-wing extremism

Social life & hobbies:

- Social interactions often virtual (DMS, group chats, gaming, video calls…)
- Friend groups often more global & diverse
- Gravitate to digital-first hobbies
- Also “classic” hobbies blended as online/offline experiences
- “Make-and-share” culture among youth (platforms with easy publication of artwork, music, and opinions)

Work:

- High importance on flexible work models, training & opportunities for remote/home office
- Seeking of meaning and flexibility
- More entrepreneurial → likely to pursue “side hustles”

UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Social Media

More than just polished life updates

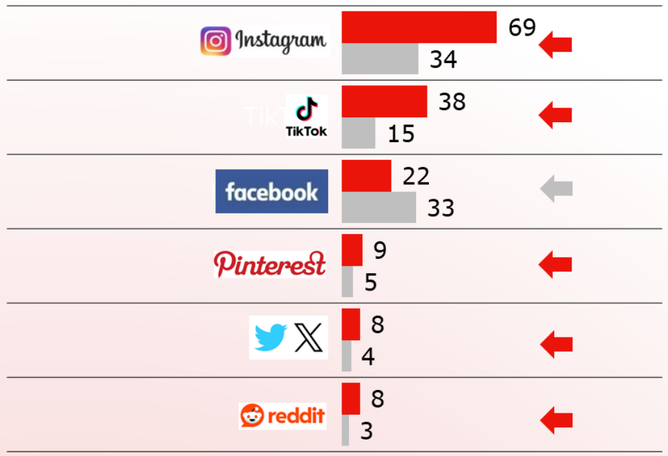
- Self-expression and identity as biggest motives
- High aversion overly “polished” content → authenticity as core value
- Immersive, video-first entertainment, community building and immediate discovery
- Primary source from news, connection, entertainment, (product) research to customer service

Nonsensical social media trends?

- Humor consists of layered irony, absurd randomness, and self-deprecation
- In-group belonging: Inside joke & meme culture that evolves very quickly
- Content that breaks with traditional sense-making → escapism from everyday “sameness”
- Content that grabs attention (often unconventional/absurd) and is relatable is more likely to be shared & go viral

Daily use of social media platforms:

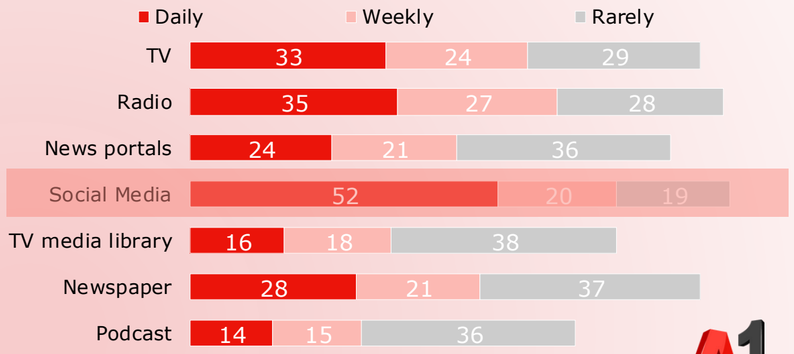
(Sinus Milieu Jugendstudie 2025)



16-19 yrs	20-24 yrs	25+ yrs
50	46	23

Main info channel for daily news:

(Sinus Milieu Jugendstudie 2025)



UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Youth as consumers

General consumption & lifestyle

- Flexible, affordable & convenient products/services highly valued
- More second-hand shopping than previous generations
- Quality is important, but with tendency to indulge in premium when it matters → Shopping often considered as “reward”
- Openness to sharing & collaborative consumption (especially for entertainment and tools)

Not just consumption but identity expression

- Buying is not just transactional → tied to identity and belonging
- Self-expression at the center of buying motives, e.g. indulging in small luxuries that reflect wellness, cultural relevance → Matcha latte, cosmetics, sneakers

Sales channels & meaning

Offline:

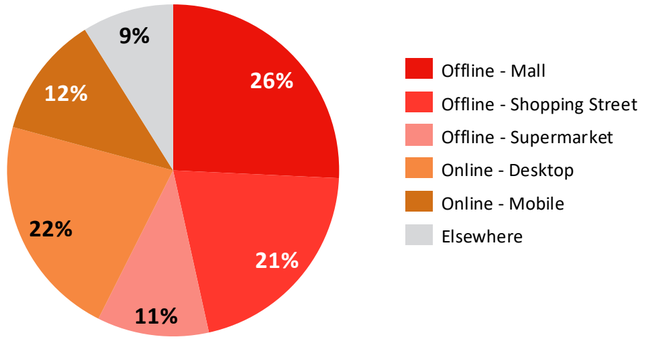
- Malls visits very popular → for social and experiential reasons; shopping as engaging outing, not “just” transaction

Online:

- Main inspiration & information point of buying journey
- Rising trend of purchasing through social media platforms (TikTok shop)

Preferred point of sale (single-entry):

(Handelsverband/Mindtake, 2019)



UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Youth as consumers

Predictors of purchase intention

1) Online brand experience – most influential (e.g. personalized ads, influencer marketing, AI, and gamification)
2) Brand knowledge – highly predictive.
3) Brand image – strong positive effect.

Secondary: Brand trust and loyalty

Lesser influence: Brand awareness and engagement → this highly correlates, but not as a single driver (!), as merely knowing a brand exists isn't enough → deeper interaction and meaning

Peer and social influences on buying

- Close personal networks (friends and family) → most persuasive
- Electronic word of mouth & broader social ties → play lesser role

- Low-involvement (everyday) tech: Strongest
- High-involvement (costly) product: Moderate
- Luxury items: Weakest (personal identity)

Expectations towards brands

- Making decisions simpler = overwhelmed and burnt out by life and social media

- Helping young consumers to connect with each other = deep need and search for community

- **Brand image and trust** matter the most: Brands that demonstrate core values such as authenticity, transparency, social responsibility, and inclusion

- **Brand awareness & engagement**: Matters too, but in combination with image & trust → authentic and engaging digital experiences with interactive content and user participation

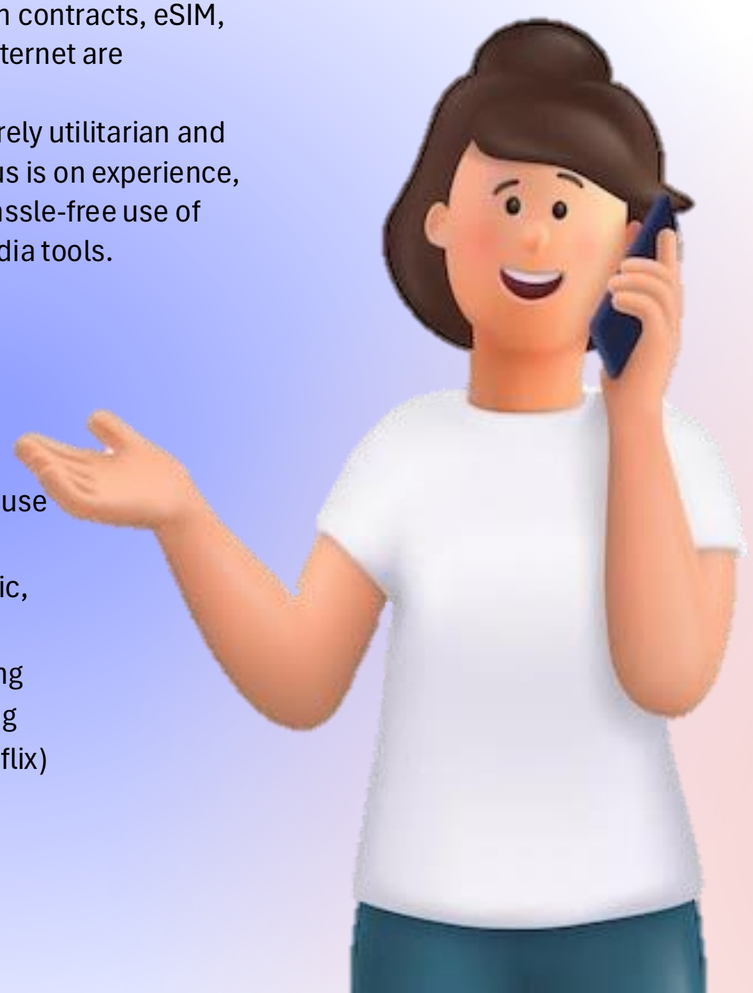
UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Telco-specific insights

Expectations to mobile provider

- Youth need for mobile providers mainly affordable, flexible & uncomplicated solutions
- Features such as no long-term contracts, eSIM, easy rate changes, and fast internet are particularly in demand
- Mobile providers currently purely utilitarian and not part of their identity – focus is on experience, immediate availability, and hassle-free use of messenger, AI, and social media tools.

Extended portfolio

- Highest use of entertainment use cases compared to other generations (e.g. games, music, streaming...)
- 50% of youth are online gaming
- 87% Youth are using streaming subscription models (e.g. Netflix)

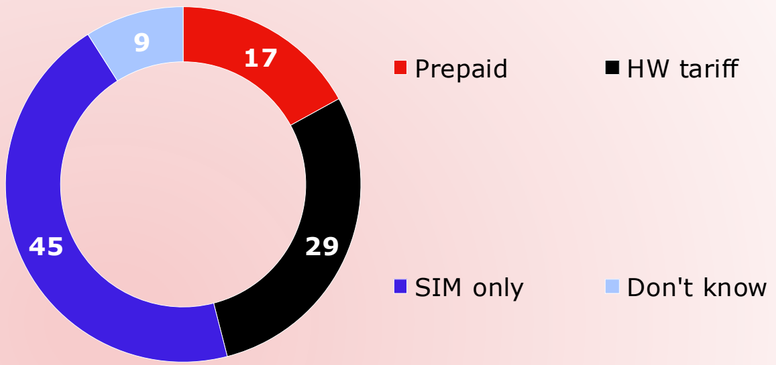


Hardware/devices:

- Brand names very important when buying smartphones
- Apple by far the most preferred hardware brand among youth (the younger, the more affinity to Apple)
- Young adults (25-29) use comparably many devices/gadgets (gaming controllers, drones, SmartHome)

Prepaid or contract preference

(Sinus Milieu Jugendstudie 2025)



UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Telco-specific insights

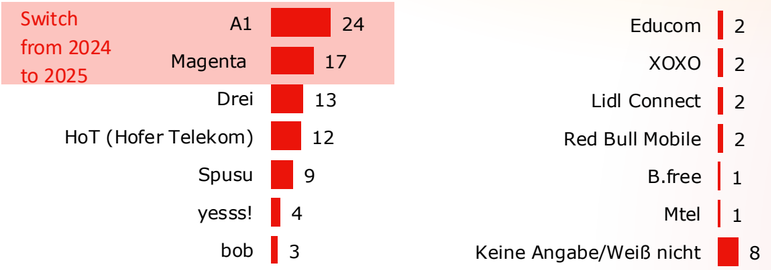
Brand image rankings

(Brand Monitor 09/25, Youth, Mobile)

Brand images	Δ Magenta to A1
is the brand that best covers my needs	**24**
clear / transparent offer, easy to understand	**22**
represents a modern, urban spirit	**19**
makes my life easier	**19**
likeable telco brand	**17**
best product and service quality	16
best price performance ratio	16
engaging for social issues	14
everything from one source	13
values loyalty	12
reliable, high quality network	8
best netquality	7
trustworthy	6

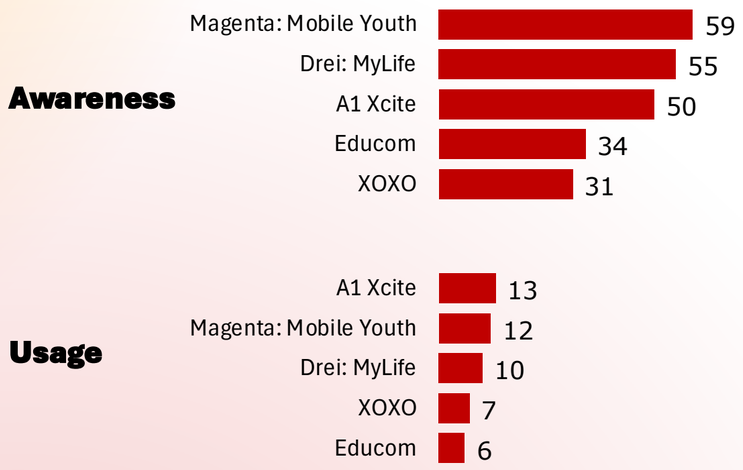
Preferred mobile provider

(Sinus Milieu Jugendstudie 2025)



Awareness and usage of youth mobile tariff

(Sinus Milieu Jugendstudie 2025)



UNDERSTANDING YOUTH | Implications

Implications

- Enable self-expression & identity as well as fostering connections
- Increase encouragement through close personal networks
- Offline points of sales in terms as experience
- Further improve overall online brand experience, brand knowledge and brand image

Open questions

- More details on brand image rankings
- More details on brand preference decisions
- Fill telco-specific insight gaps regarding buying decision
- More detailed insights regarding mobile provider value proposition
- Current data on point of sales preferences for Austrian Youth

youth

TARGET GROUPS

TARGET GROUPS | Target group slicing

youth

By age groups

18–29yrs
cut off legal age & GenZ

18–24yrs
primarily in education/
living at home

25–29yrs
primarily (starting)
work/first home

Depending on the source, almost whole target group is Gen Z (cut off 1995-1997) → differences in habits/values to millennials

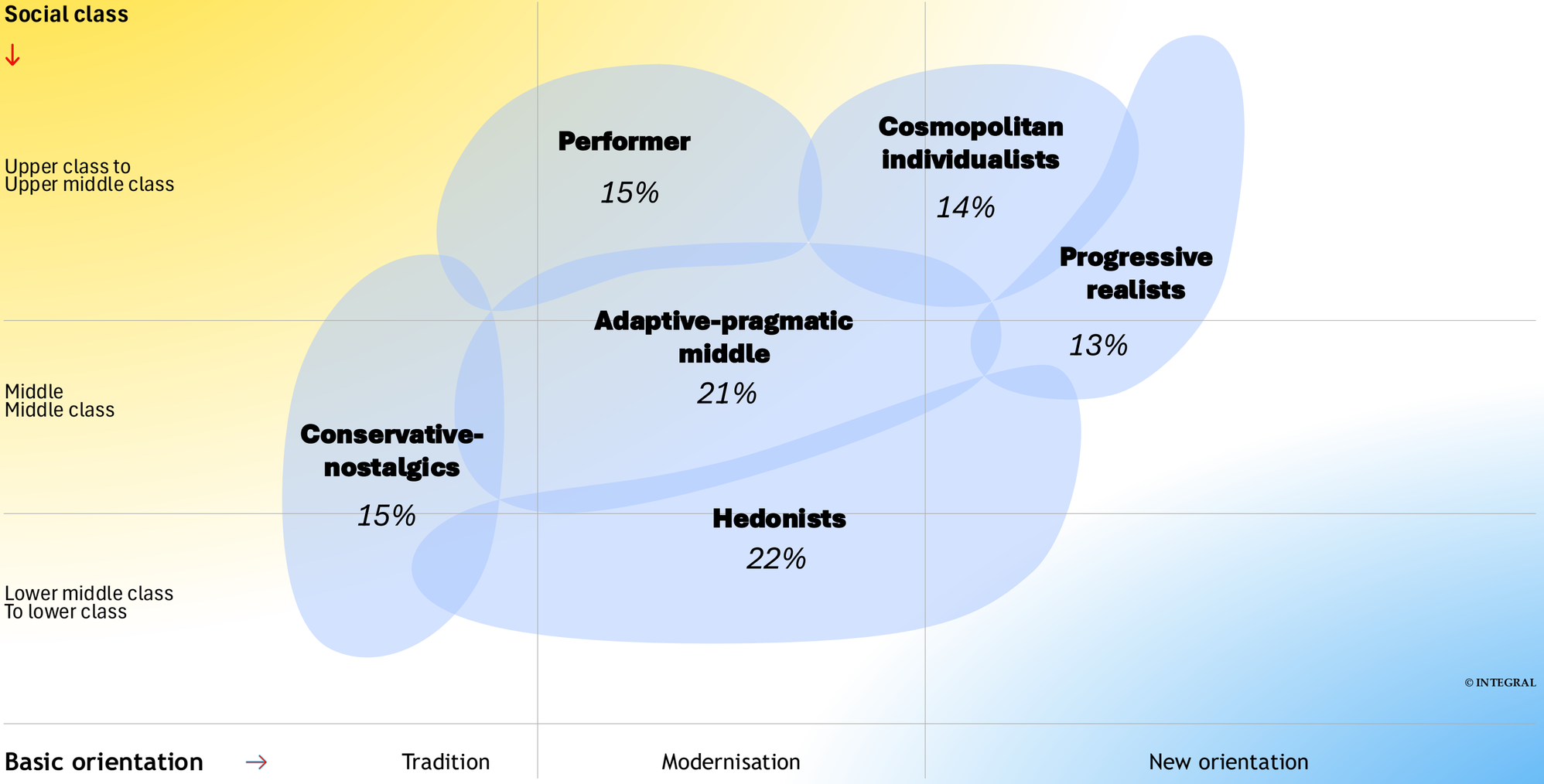
Primarily to be used in targeting, reporting and filtering of "main" life events (e.g. first job vs. end of school)

By Sinus Milieus

- Utilization of Youth Sinus Milieus form Integral Market Research Institute
- Sinus Milieus group together people who share similar outlooks on life and lifestyles → People with similar basic orientations, mentalities and values have similarities in their consumption, lifestyle, tastes and living environment

To be used in general communication, brand perception & selection of events/sponsoring

TARGET GROUPS | Sinus milieus explained

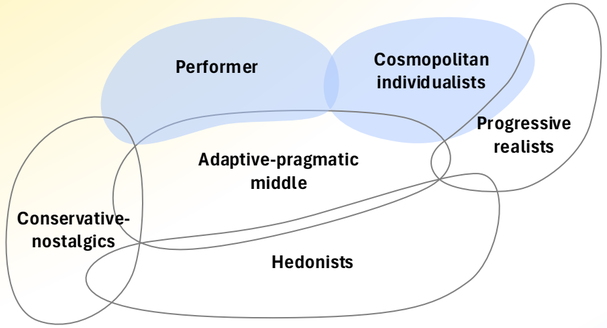


TARGET GROUPS | Sinus milieus explained

Performer

- **High priority given to career and success, achiever mindset and go-getter orientation**
- Characterised by determination, ambition and performance optimism
- Global, cosmopolitan orientation
- **High lifestyle orientation**, high importance of aesthetics and design, sustainability only as lifestyle component
- Active and diverse leisure activities
- Strong emphasis on personal responsibility: ultimately, everyone is responsible for their own happiness and success

Life goal:
Positioning themselves well in the modern, global world efficiency and success as the basis for a life of prosperity – combined with the pursuit of personal fulfilment and an intense life.



Cosmopolitan individualists

- **Individually combined patchwork of values** comprising performance, efficiency, success, self-fulfilment and hedonism
- **Conscious distancing from conventions**, established norms and narrow-mindedness
- High sensitivity to diversity and equality, but relatively little interest in climate change and sustainability
- Confident navigation of the digital, globalised world
- Focus on success and advancement, but with moderation and purpose – time for private projects too

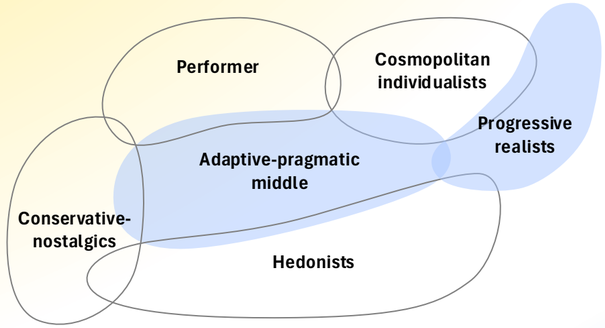
Life goal:
Explore the world creatively, pursue exciting projects and develop yourself further

TARGET GROUPS | Sinus milieus explained

Adaptive -pragmatic middle

- Combination of diligence, honesty and reliability with modern and hedonistic values
- **Pronounced pragmatism**, high adaptability and flexibility
- **Search for belonging and security in** one's immediate environment
- Strong focus on leisure and consumption. Functional, benefit-oriented thinking: ‘What's in it for me?’
- Increasingly unsettled due to the current crises
- Search for stability and orientation and for concrete recommendations for behaviour

Life goal:
Making something of your own life, finding a recognised place in society, security and well-being among family and friends



Progressive realists

- Advocates of a fundamental paradigm shift
- **A sense of responsibility** and a pioneering spirit combined with a strong sense of realism and pragmatism
- **An environmentally and climate-conscious lifestyle**, but without an ideology of sacrifice and doom-mongering rhetoric
- Demand for change in the areas of equality and diversity
- Desire for freedom, self-fulfilment, fun, enjoyment and sensuality
- Keen interest in other countries and cultures and global contexts

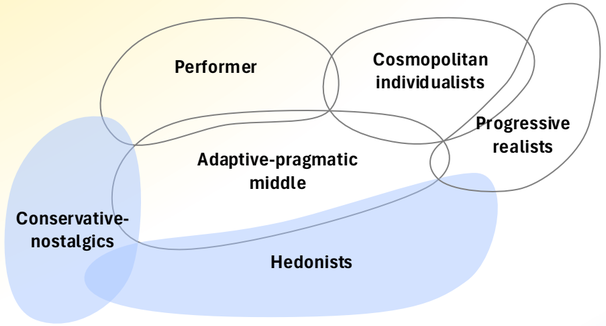
Life goal:
Advocating for a fundamental paradigm shift, for changing the world – and having fun doing it.

TARGET GROUPS | Sinus milieus explained

Conservative-nostalgics

- Conservative values: **there are generally binding rules that (should) apply to everyone**
- Low affinity for lifestyle and consumerism
- Professional and social establishment through fulfilment of duties, diligence and willingness to adapt
- **Vehement demand for 'normality'** and a classic normal biography
- **Orientation towards the order of the past**, little interest in current political issues
- Strong connection to Austria or homeland, high importance of the local environment, strong connection to nature.

Life goal:
A harmonious, fulfilling life with family in a secure and predictable environment



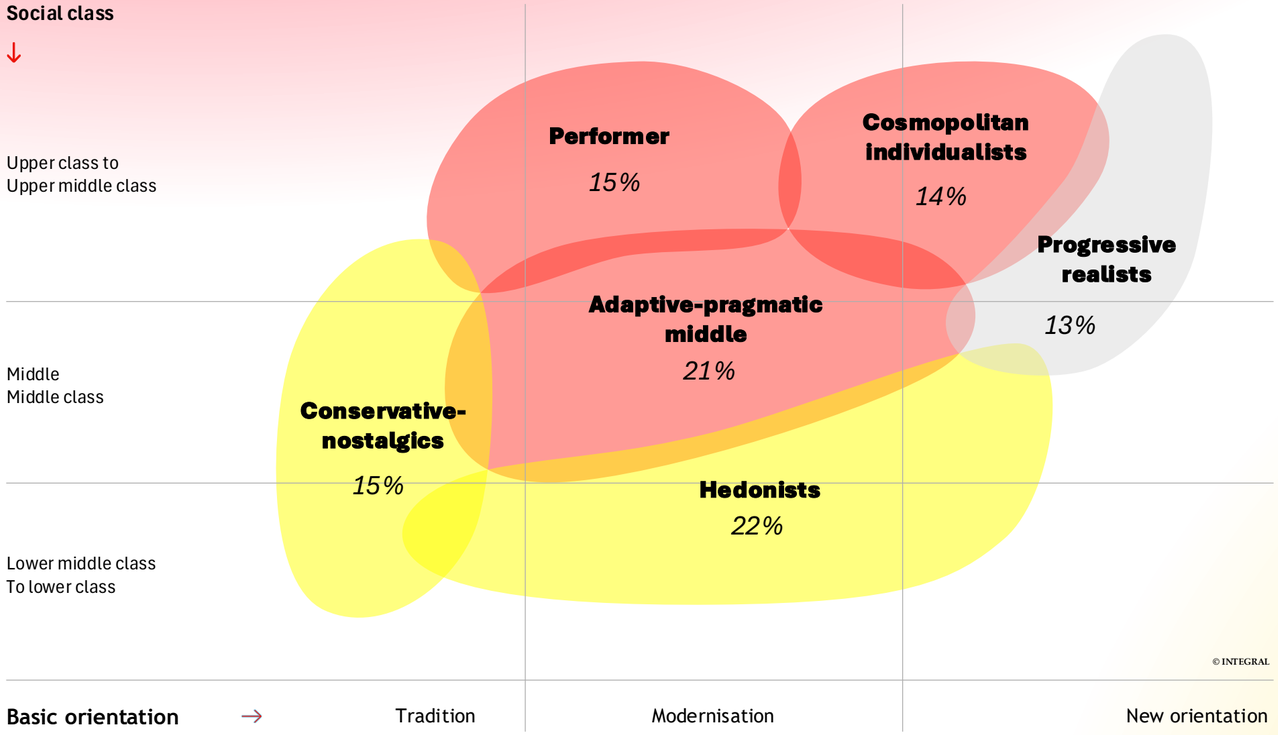
Hedonists

- Strong focus on leisure: performing well at work, but **'real life' happens in your free time**
- Strong differentiation between leisure interests, sports, fashion, cinema, crafts, music, etc
- Rejection of traditional norms and conventions
- **Living in the here and now,** with as few restrictions as possible
- Strong consumerism and brand orientation
- Affinity for lifestyle trends
- Increasingly annoyed by the dictates of sustainability and political correctness

Life goal:
A pleasant life without too much effort, with lots of fun and entertainment

TARGET GROUP | Sinus milieu results

Positioning across sinus milieus for A1



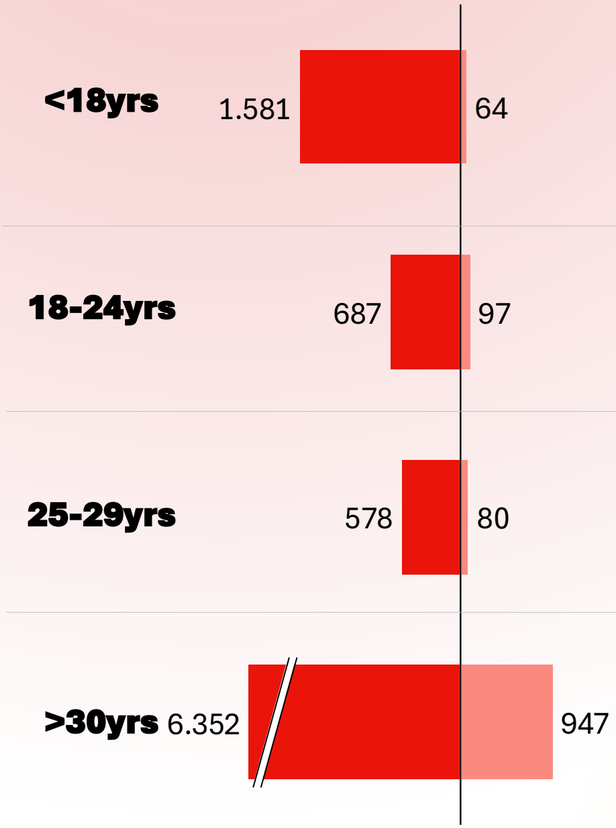
Comparison to competition

	Totat	PER	KOS	PRO	PRA	KON	HED
A1	**24**	24	29	13	30	23	21
Magenta	**17**	13	22	16	16	22	15
Drei	**13**	12	10	9	17	12	15
HoT	**12**	18	11	12	9	18	6
Spusu	**9**	10	5	22	8	6	7
yesss!	**4**	5	3	3	2	5	6
bob	**3**	1	5	5	3	3	1

- Yesss! to be positioned further towards „ conservative nostalgics“ to better capture HoT customers
- A1 to be positioned further towards „cosmopolitan individuals“ to better capture Magenta customers and towards the „adaptive-pragmatic middle“ to capture Drei customers

youth TARGETS

TARGETS | Targets per youth segment



	Austrian population	A1 Subscribers	A1 Subscribers 25 vs 24	A1 Penetration	ARPU	AMBITION 2026 A1 Subscribers 26 vs 25
<18yrs	1.581	64	+6.9k | +11%	4%	€ 17,9	
18-24yrs	687	97	+4.8k | +5%	**14%**	€ 25,5	+9.6k | +10%
25-29yrs	578	80	+0.9k | +1%	**14%**	€ 28,4	+1.8k | +2%
>30yrs	6.352	947	+25.3k | +3%	15%	€ 27,0	

+100% of the growing rate of subscribers 25 vs 24

+100% of the growing rate of subscribers 25 vs 24

youth

MEASURES

MEASURES | Continuous outside-in perspective

To answer unresolved questions and to ensure continuous insights into the target group, a mix of different market research methods is necessary:

2025	2026		
Build hypothesis around Youth	**Test hypothesis**	**Deep Dives** (specific topics, resulting from hypothesis)	**Continuous insights & monitoring**

0. Existing data
Status Quo summary on existing internal and external resources → basis for assumptions/hypothesis of Youth

1. Q1 Focus groups
Based on hypothesis | End of January

3. Brand Monitor / NPS
Boost Youth in Brand Monitor Samples 2026 as already 2025 and deliver insights deep dive in NPS Analysis

3. Co-Creation
Based on results co-creation of specific topic/issue | February

4. Quantitative Insights
Validate Qualitative Insights with Quantitative Research

5. Social Listening
Source for perception of A1 image and general attitude towards A1 in Youth segment

6. AI Suite
Beatrix Intelligence Suite (FehrAdvice) → testing of ideas/communication for reactions/likeability of Youth in AI simulation
Start with February POC

MEASURES | Key pillars for 2026

	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
VALUE PROPOSITION • Value added services (e.g. gaming, streaming) • Evaluation of potential cooperation partners (e.g. Ö-Ticket)		Evaluation of new services & cooperations incl. results of Q1 focus groups					**Promos end of school & school start:** • Entertainment bundle (tbd) • HW or SIMply focus /tbd)					
				Wiener Linien Cooperation -10% on Xcite tariff for WL customers				Pick&Swap Launch				
COMMUNICATION • Conception & launch of Youth Proposition tailored to sinus-milieu target groups • Events & Sponsoring (e.g. ESC, 3x3, new cooperations – perhaps togehter with Red Bull)		Conception Youth Propositon		Launch Youth Image Propositon								
		Further evaluation of potential events/sponsoring			ESC Sponsoring							
SALES • Improvement of attractiveness of sales channels for Youth (e.g. gaming experience hubs in shops, more youthful online shop experience)		Evaluation of measures for physical POS				Implementation tbd						
		Evaluation of measures for digital POS										

MEASURES | Key pillars for 2026

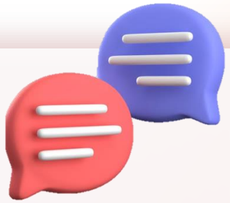
Value Proposition

Value adds

Enrichment of product or bundling e.g. video/music streaming, gaming,...

Cooperations

Youth relevant companies for specific advantages (e.g. Garmin smart-watches, drones, Ö-Ticket...)



Communication

Content

- Usage of youth slang in communication
- Participation in social media trends

Ad types & communication channels

e.g. native selling or increase of presence in channels preferred by Youth (Youtube)

Image

Activities beyond SoMe → such as events/sponsoring (e.g. ESC public viewing by A1, Pride?)

Sales

PUSH

Targeted E-Mail/SMS/App | e.g. gamification elements or usage of our Storifyme elements in A1 App for youth

PULL

- Creation of experience hubs in shops | e.g. gaming lounge
- Incentivize store visits | e.g. raffle, collabs w/ local influencers
- “Takeover” events w/ youth ambassadors | e.g. music sessions, gaming duels

MEASURES | Communication - Youth Proposition

Inputs	Results Market Research - Focus groups - Co-Creation	External insights - Consumer Trends 2026 - Austrian Articles on Youth	Sinus Milieu Input - „How does the image/band need to look like for our three sinus milieus?“
Definition **Target Output**	Themes - Recognition/definition of themes	Definition Output - Matching of themes and sinus milieu expectations	Briefing Agency
Output Multiple Iterations	Testing selection - Definition of critical testing elements → „What needs to work?“	Operationalization - „What does the Youth Proposition mean concretely in terms of different functions?“	
Testing In Simulation	Beatrix Simulation - Testing if concept (elements) work for target group	Revision - With results of simulation	